

SCHOOLS OF BUDDHISM

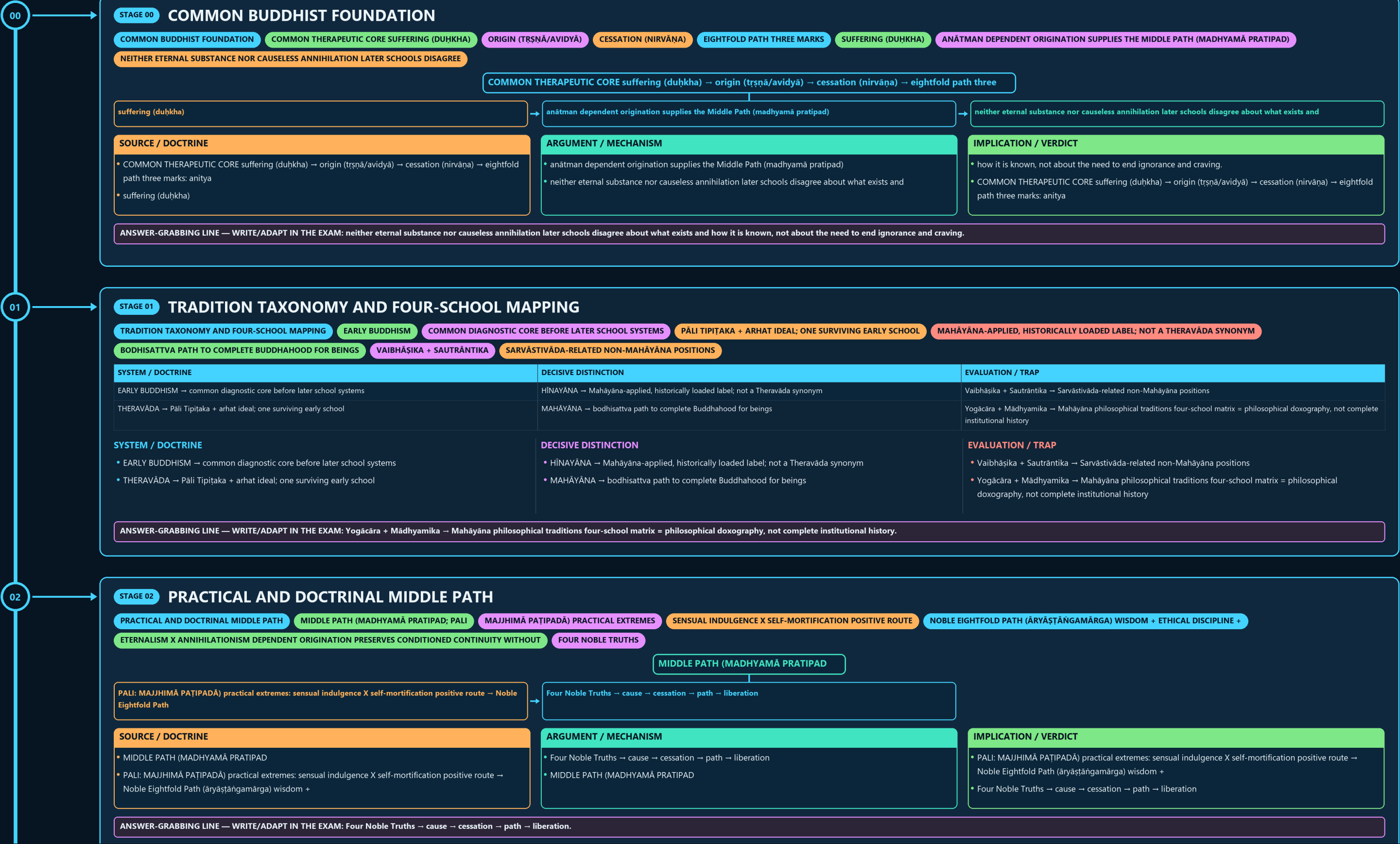
COMMON BUDDHIST FOUNDATION → TRADITION TAXONOMY AND FOUR-SCHOOL → PRACTICAL AND DOCTRINAL MIDDLE → TWELVE-LINKED DEPENDENT ORIGATION → MOMENTARINESS AND NO-SELF → ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE

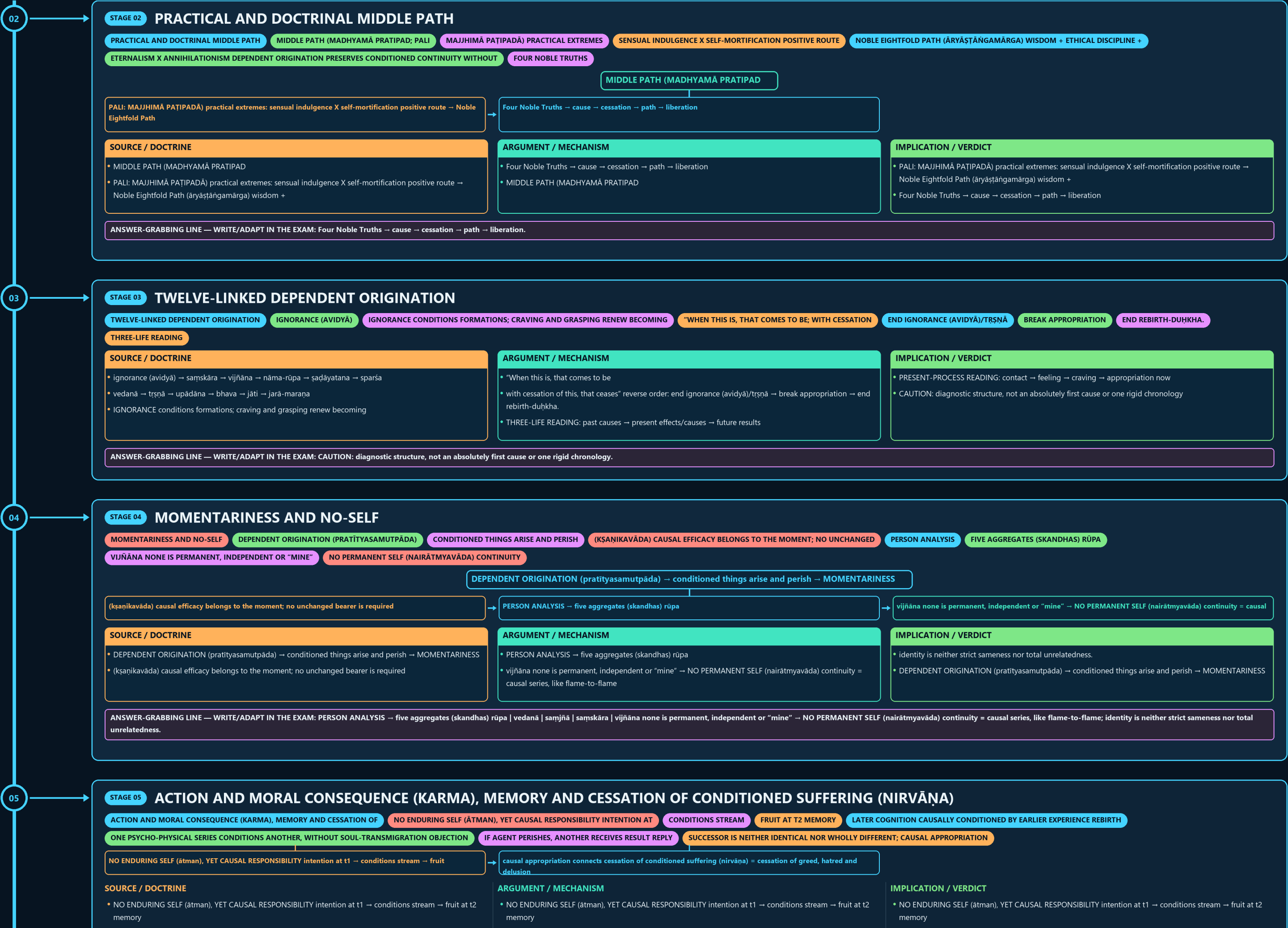
Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g15 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles





ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PERSON ANALYSIS → five aggregates (skandhas) rūpa | vedanā | saṃjñā | saṃskāra | vijñāna none is permanent, independent or “mine” → NO PERMANENT SELF (nairātmyavāda) continuity = causal series, like flame-to-flame; identity is neither strict sameness nor total unrelatedness.

05

STAGE 05 ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA), MEMORY AND CESSATION OF CONDITIONED SUFFERING (NIRVĀṆA)

ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (KARMA), MEMORY AND CESSATION OF

NO ENDURING SELF (ĀTMAN), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY INTENTION AT

CONDITIONS STREAM

FRUIT AT T2 MEMORY

LATER COGNITION CAUSALLY CONDITIONED BY EARLIER EXPERIENCE REBIRTH

ONE PSYCHO-PHYSICAL SERIES CONDITIONS ANOTHER, WITHOUT SOUL-TRANSMIGRATION OBJECTION

IF AGENT PERISHES, ANOTHER RECEIVES RESULT REPLY

SUCCESSOR IS NEITHER IDENTICAL NOR WHOLLY DIFFERENT; CAUSAL APPROPRIATION

NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit

causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory
- causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory
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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory
- causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of

MECHANISM / VERDICT — NO ENDURING SELF (ātman), YET CAUSAL RESPONSIBILITY intention at t1 → conditions stream → fruit at t2 memory = later cognition causally conditioned by earlier experience rebirth = one psycho-physical series conditions another, without soul-transmigration objection: if agent perishes, another receives result reply: successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: if agent perishes, another receives result reply: successor is neither identical nor wholly different; causal appropriation connects cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa) = cessation of greed, hatred and delusion, not destruction of a substance-self.

06

STAGE 06 ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

ABHIDHARMA SCHOOL FORK

BUDDHIST REALITY

KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

NON-MAHĀYĀNA ABHIDHARMA MAHĀYĀNA

VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA YOGĀCĀRA MĀDHYAMIKA EXTERNAL EXTERNAL OBJECTS COGNITION EMPTINESS

SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO

BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

NON-MAHĀYĀNA ABHIDHARMA MAHĀYĀNA

Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyamika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred

from ideas only all intrinsic nature (svabhāva) directly and causal effects perceived

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE
- NON-MAHĀYĀNA ABHIDHARMA MAHĀYĀNA

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- Vaibhāṣika Sautrāntika Yogācāra Mādhyamika external external objects cognition emptiness of dharmas inferred
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IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO MIX.
- BUDDHIST REALITY / KNOWLEDGE DEBATE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SCHOOL LABELS MARK EPISTEMIC/ONTOLOGICAL POSITIONS, NOT FOUR PATHS TO MIX.

07

STAGE 07 VAIBHĀṢIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA

VAIBHĀṢIKA AND SAUTRĀNTIKA

ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA EXTERNAL OBJECT REAL DHARMAS REAL MOMENTARY

DHARMAS EXIST ONLY PRESENT CAUSAL MOMENT STRESSED COGNITION GRASPS

SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT

OBJECT-MOMENT IS GONE WHEN AWARENESS OCCURS

THEREFORE COGNITION PRESENTS AN IMAGE, FROM WHICH EXTERNAL CAUSE

REPRESENTATIVE REALISM MUST EXPLAIN CORRESPONDENCE.

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental
image past/future sarvāstivāda: dharmas exist only present causal moment stressed cognition grasps object represents object

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

SAUTRĀNTIKA ARGUMENT: object-moment is gone when awareness occurs
therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

EVALUATION / TRAP

PRESSURE: representative realism must explain correspondence.
ISSUE VAIBHĀṢIKA SAUTRĀNTIKA external object real dharmas real momentary causes access direct perception inferred from mental

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: therefore cognition presents an image, from which external cause is inferred.

08

STAGE 08

YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA

YOGĀCĀRA AND MĀDHYAMIKA

CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (VIJÑĀNAVĀDA) MĀDHYAMIKA

EMPTINESS (ŚŪNYATĀ) SUBJECT-OBJECT DUALITY IS CONSTRUCTED ALL THINGS LACK

REPRESENTATION-ONLY DEPENDENT ARISING

EMPTINESS STORE-CONSCIOUSNESS (ĀLAYA-VIJÑĀNA) STORES BĪJA TENDENCIES TWO TRUTHS

PARAMĀRTHA THREE NATURES

PARIKALPITA, TETRALEMMA REJECTS IS

IS-NOT PARATANTRA, PARINIṢPANNA BOTH

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- YOGĀCĀRA / CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (vijñānavāda) MĀDHYAMIKA / EMPTINESS (śūnyatā) subject-object duality is constructed all things lack intrinsic
- nature (svabhāva) vijñapti-mātra: representation-only dependent arising = emptiness store-consciousness (ālaya-vijñāna) stores bīja tendencies two truths: saṃvṛti /

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- paramārtha three natures: parikalpita, tetralemma rejects is / is-not paratantra, pariniṣpanna both / neither as ultimate capture
- CONVERGENCE: dissolve reification

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- DIFFERENCE: Yogācāra privileges purified cognition, while Mādhyamika empties even consciousness and emptiness itself.
- YOGĀCĀRA / CONSCIOUSNESS-ONLY DOCTRINE (vijñānavāda) MĀDHYAMIKA / EMPTINESS (śūnyatā) subject-object duality is constructed all things lack intrinsic

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONVERGENCE: dissolve reification; DIFFERENCE: Yogācāra privileges purified cognition, while Mādhyamika empties even consciousness and emptiness itself.

09

STAGE 09

CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE

CRITIQUE AND PYQ ANSWER SPINE

FLUX CANNOT EXPLAIN CONTINUITY

ANĀTMAN WEAKENS AGENCY

EMPTINESS (ŚŪNYATĀ) IS NIHILISM

CAUSAL SERIES

DEPENDENT RESPONSIBILITY

EMPTINESS DENIES SELF-NATURE, NOT FUNCTION

ANSWER RAIL COMMON CORE

OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity

→

anātman weakens agency

→

emptiness (śūnyatā) is nihilism

→

REPLIES: causal series

→

dependent responsibility

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- OBJECTIONS: flux cannot explain continuity
- anātman weakens agency
- emptiness (śūnyatā) is nihilism
- REPLIES: causal series

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- dependent responsibility
- emptiness denies self-nature, not function
- ANSWER RAIL common core → twelve links → momentariness → five-skandha no-self
- action and moral consequence (karma)/memory reply → four-school fork → exact school comparison

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- objection/reply → qualified verdict
- CLOSE: Buddhism replaces substance with conditioned process
- its schools progressively debate whether external dharmas, cognition, or any intrinsic nature can be retained.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE: Buddhism replaces substance with conditioned process; its schools progressively debate whether external dharmas, cognition, or any intrinsic nature can be retained.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE

LAYER-PLACEMENT NOTE ALL LAYER 3 MATERIAL FROM THE LEGACY

IT SHOULD REFINE A CORE ANSWER, NOT DISPLACE THE

LAYER 3 - ADVANCED ADVANCED DERIVATION AND SCHOOL DIVERGENCE

IT DIAGNOSES THE STRUCTURE OF CONDITIONED BECOMING HERE AND

THIS AVOIDS ETERNALISM BECAUSE NO UNCHANGED SELF GROUNDS THE

THE DOCTRINE SUPPORTS DIFFERENT ONTOLOGICAL CONCLUSIONS.

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Layer-placement note
- Layer-placement note All Layer 3 material from the legacy complete session is retained here after practice.
- It should refine a core answer, not displace the printed syllabus.
- LAYER 3 - ADVANCED Advanced derivation and school divergence Dependent origination is not a search for the universe's first cause.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- It diagnoses the structure of conditioned becoming here and now.
- This avoids eternalism because no unchanged self grounds the process, and avoids annihilationism because causal continuity remains.
- The doctrine supports different ontological conclusions.
- Mādhyamika argues that whatever depends on conditions lacks intrinsic nature (svabhāva) and is therefore empty.

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- Vaibhāṣika and Sautrāntika instead emphasise that causally functioning conditioned events are real.
- Their disagreement concerns ultimate status, not whether dependent arising occurs.
- The strongest challenge is regress: if every event is conditioned, what explains the chain as a whole?
- The Buddhist reply is therapeutic and structural rather than foundational—the task is to

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.